

Chapter 4

Communication

Lesson 4.1: Communication

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1. Recognize that communication is inherent in every nurse-patient interaction.
2. Discuss the concepts of verbal and nonverbal communication.
3. Discuss the impact of nonverbal communication.
4. Recognize assertive communication as the most appropriate communication style.
5. Use various therapeutic communication techniques.

Lesson 4.1: Communication

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6. Identify various factors that have the potential to affect communication.
7. Discuss potential barriers to communication.
8. Recognize trust as the foundation for all effective interaction.
9. Apply the nursing process to patients experiencing difficulty with verbally communicating.
10. Apply therapeutic communication techniques to patients with special communication needs.

Overview

- Requirements for communication
 - Sender
 - Receiver
- One-way communication
- Two-way communication

Verbal Communication

● Verbal communication

- Involves the use of spoken or written words or symbols
- Connotative meaning
- Denotative meaning
- Jargon

Nonverbal Communication

- Message transmitted without use of words
 - Voice
 - Eye contact
 - Physical appearance
 - Gestures
 - Posture

Consistency of Verbal and Nonverbal Communication

- Nonverbal communication is powerful
- If nonverbal communication is inconsistent with verbal communication, it is likely that the nonverbal message will be received

Styles of Communication

- Assertive communication

- Takes into account feelings and needs of patient, and honors nurse's rights
- Interactions are even-sided

- Aggressive communication

- Interacting with an overpowering and forceful manner
- Meets one's own personal needs
- Destructive and nontherapeutic

- Unassertive communication

- Agreeing to do what is requested
- Creates additional problems

Establishing a Therapeutic Relationship

- Interaction between nurse and patient is caring, sincere, empathetic, and trustworthy
- Ensures patient is focus of each interaction
- Establishes trust
- Maintains professional boundaries

Therapeutic Communication

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● Nonverbal

- Listening
- Silence
- Touch

Therapeutic Communication

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● Verbal

- Conveying acceptance
- Closed questioning
- Open-ended questioning
- Restating
- Paraphrasing
- Clarifying
- Focusing
- Reflecting
- Stating observations
- Offering information
- Summarizing
- Using humor

Nontherapeutic Communication

- Blocks development of trusting and therapeutic relationship

Factors Affecting Communication

- Posture and positioning
- Space and territoriality
- Environment
- Level of trust
- Language barriers
- Culture
- Age and gender
- Physiological factors
- Psychosocial factors

Barriers to Communication

- False reassurance
- Giving advice or personal opinions
- False assumptions
- Approval or disapproval
- Automatic responses
- Defensiveness
- Arguing
- Asking for explanations
- Changing the subject

Trust

- A trusting relationship is essential to an effective nurse-patient interaction
- Trust allows the interaction to progress past superficial social interaction

Nursing Process

- Assessment
- Patient Problem
 - Compromised verbal communication
- Patient goals and planning
- Implementation
 - Depends on type of impaired communication
- Evaluation

Communication in Special Situations

- Ventilator-dependent patients
- Aphasic patients
- Unresponsive patients

Alternative Methods for Communicating

- Clock-face communication
- Computer-assisted communication
- Eye blinks
- Lip-reading
- Magnetic boards with plastic letters
- Paper and pencil or magic slate
- Picture board
- Sign language
- Word or picture cards